CORE FALSE BELIEF #2 · MY WORTH

"I am worthless."

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Where it often comes from

Many people learn this belief from the way they were treated: being called names, put down, ignored, used, or compared unfavorably with others. When love depended on grades, looks, money, or behavior, a child can conclude that a person is only worth what he or she produces. Losses such as a divorce, a job loss, a disability, or growing older can reawaken it later. Our culture adds to it by measuring people by success, popularity, and appearance.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture places a person's worth in God, not in performance. Jesus said that not one sparrow falls apart from the Father, and that you are worth more than many sparrows. God calls His people precious and honored in His sight. The clearest measure of your worth is the price that was paid for you: not silver or gold, but the precious blood of Christ. Your worth was settled by God before you did anything right or wrong, and nothing you do can add to or subtract from His love.

> *"Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from the will of your Father. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows"* (Matthew 10:29–31).

Also see

> "For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life you inherited from your forefathers, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or spot" (1 Peter 1:18–19).

> "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life" (Isaiah 43:4).

> "What is man that You are mindful of him, or the son of man that You care for him? You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor" (Psalm 8:4–5).

> "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us" (Romans 5:8).

Common self-statements

- I am not worth anything.
- Other people matter; I don't.
- If I disappeared, no one would notice.
- I have nothing to offer.
- I only matter when I am useful.
- I don't deserve good things.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Giving myself a single word, "worthless," that ignores everything else that is true about me.
- Mental filter: Remembering every failure or rejection and overlooking the times I helped, loved, or was valued.
- Emotional reasoning: Concluding I have no worth because I feel worthless.
- Comparison: Measuring my value against other people's gifts, looks, or success.

Challenging questions

- Who decides what a person is worth: other people, my feelings, or God?
- Where did I first learn that I was worthless?
- Would I call a friend worthless for the same reasons I call myself worthless?
- What price did God pay for me, and what does that say about my value?
- Is my worth something I earn, or something I was given?
- What would change in my day if I believed I was precious to God?

Truth summary

> My worth does not come from what I do, how I look, or what others say. God made me, values me, and paid the highest price for me in Christ. I may feel worthless at times, but feelings are not the final word. I am precious and honored in His sight.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God
- Christ, Sacrifice of
- God, All Loving
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

Dear Younger Me — MercyMe
Past wounds and choices do not have to become a person's permanent identity.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am worthless"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am worthless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who decides what I am worth?
- ☐ Where did I learn that I was worthless?
- ☐ Would I say this about a friend?
- ☐ What price did God pay for me?
- ☐ Is my worth earned or given?
- ☐ What would change if I believed I was precious?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am worth more than many sparrows.
- ☐ I was bought with the precious blood of Christ.
- ☐ My worth was given, not earned.
- ☐ Feeling worthless is not the same as being worthless.
- ☐ I am precious and honored in God's sight.
- ☐ I can treat myself as someone God values.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 10:29–31**
  "Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from the will of your Father. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ **1 Peter 1:18–19**
  "For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life you inherited from your forefathers, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or spot."
- ☐ **Isaiah 43:4**
  "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When I felt worthless: Each day, write one moment when you felt worthless. Note what triggered it and write one truth from this card that answers it.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 10:29–31 becomes: "David can write: "God sees every sparrow, and I am worth more than many sparrows. My worth is settled by Him.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Write your "worth" list. List five things God says about you from the verses on this card. Read the list each morning for one week.
- [ ] Treat yourself as valuable for one day. Do one ordinary act of care for yourself, such as a good meal, rest, or a walk, as if you were caring for someone God loves.
- [ ] Notice the put-downs. Each time you call yourself worthless or stupid, stop and replace it with a sentence you would say to a friend.
- [ ] Let someone see your value. Accept one compliment this week without arguing. Simply say, "Thank you."

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I am worthless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I treated myself as valuable
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am worthless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have measured my worth by what others said and by what I could do. Thank You that You call me precious and that Christ gave Himself for me. When I feel worthless, help me believe what You say instead of what I feel. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.